

5.4 Applications of Integration

Theorem (Net Change Theorem): The integral of a rate of change is the *net change*:

$$\int_a^b F'(x) dx = F(b) - F(a)$$

Examples:

- Integral of *volume/sec* is net change in *volume*.
- Integral of *tons of pollution/hour* is net change in *tons of pollution*.
- Integral of *velocity* is the net change in *position*.

Example 1: Suppose that oil starts leaking from a tank at a rate of $100 - 5t$ gallons per minute at time t from when the leaking starts.

- a) What does $\int_0^{120} (100 - 5t) dt$ represent?

This integral represents the total number of gallons leaked from the tank within the first 2 hours (120 minutes).

- b) Find the total number of gallons leaked in the first half-hour.

$$\int_0^{30} (100 - 5t) dt = \left(100t + \frac{5}{2}t^2 \right) \Big|_0^{30} = 100(30) - \frac{5}{2}(30)^2 - 0 = 3000 - 2250 = 750 \text{ gallons}$$

Example 2: At 4:00am, the layer of ice on a lake was 6in. thick. Its thickness is increasing at a rate of $0.2t$ inches per hour where t represents the number of hours since 4:00am.

- a) How thick was the ice at noon that same day?

Thickness at noon = current thickness + net change over 8 hours

$$\text{Thickness at noon} = 6 + \int_0^8 0.2t dt = 6 + \left(0.1t^2 \right) \Big|_0^8 = 6 + 0.1(8)^2 - 0.1(0)^2 = 6 + 6.4 = 12.4 \text{ inches}$$

- b) How much thickness was gained from 6:00am to noon that same day?

$$\text{Thickness gained} = \int_2^8 0.2t dt = \left(0.1t^2 \right) \Big|_2^8 = 0.1(8)^2 - 0.1(2)^2 = 6.4 - 0.4 = 6 \text{ inches}$$

Note: Finding the *total distance* travelled is different than computing the *total displacement*.

- *Displacement* represents a *Net Change* and so quantities of distance are measured as positive or negative.
- With *total distance*, all quantities are regarded as positive.

Example 3:

A particle moves along a line so that its velocity at time t is $v(t) = t^2 - t - 6$ (measured in meters per second).

- a) Find the displacement of the particle during the time period $1 \leq t \leq 4$.

$$\begin{aligned} \text{displacement} &= \int_1^4 (t^2 - t + 6) dt = \left(\frac{t^3}{3} - \frac{t^2}{2} + 6t \right) \Big|_1^4 = \left[\frac{4^3}{3} - \frac{4^2}{2} + 6(4) \right] - \left[\frac{1^3}{3} - \frac{1^2}{2} + 6(1) \right] \\ &= \frac{64}{3} - 8 + 24 - \frac{1}{3} + \frac{1}{2} + 6 \\ &= -\frac{9}{2} \text{ meters} \end{aligned}$$

The total *net change* in the particle's position is $-\frac{9}{2}$ meters. This means that the particle moved 4.5m to the left.

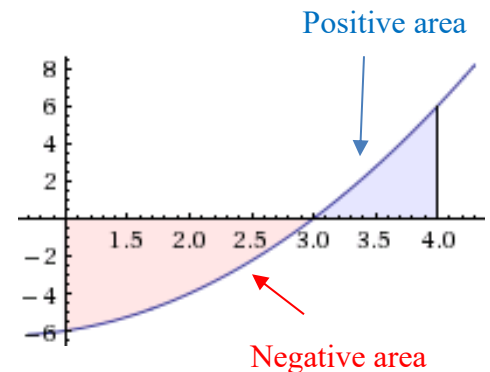
- b) Find the distance traveled during this time period.

We must first find when the particle is at rest.

$$v(t) = t^2 - t - 6 = (t-3)(t-2)$$

$$v(t) = 0 \text{ only when } t = 3.$$

We can see that when $t < 3$, $v(t) < 0$ so we can simply multiply this portion of the curve by (-1) to make it positive.



$$\begin{aligned} \text{Total Distance Travelled} &= \int_1^4 |v(t)| dt = \int_1^3 -v(t) dt + \int_3^4 v(t) dt = \int_1^3 (-t^2 + t + 6) dt + \int_3^4 (t^2 - t - 6) dt \\ &= \left(-\frac{t^3}{3} + \frac{t^2}{2} + 6t \right) \Big|_1^3 + \left(\frac{t^3}{3} - \frac{t^2}{2} - 6t \right) \Big|_3^4 \\ &= \left[-9 + \frac{9}{2} + 18 \right] - \left[-\frac{1}{3} + \frac{1}{2} + 6 \right] + \left[\frac{64}{3} - 8 - 24 \right] - \left[9 - \frac{9}{2} - 18 \right] \\ &= \frac{61}{6} \text{ meters} \end{aligned}$$